

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Dr Fouzia Moolla

Address: 18 Queens Acre Cheam SM3 8DH

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer made comments in support of the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment: Dear Sutton Council Planning Team

I am writing in support of the planning application for the change of use of the former ambulance center in our local area, which the local Muslim community has purchased with the intention of converting it into a mosque and community facility.

I live locally and I strongly support this proposal. One of the main reasons is that this site is within walking and cycling distance for many residents. A local mosque in an accessible location would reduce the need for people to drive to places of worship further afield, which is what many families currently have to do. In practical terms, this would help to reduce unnecessary car journeys, ease pressure on surrounding roads, and support a more environmentally responsible way for people to meet their faith and community needs.

For many Muslims, prayer in congregation is a core part of religious life. It is not only about worship, but also about building a sense of connection, structure, and shared responsibility. A local mosque provides a safe and welcoming place where people see one another regularly, look out for one another, and develop stronger relationships across different ages and backgrounds. This strengthens community cohesion and helps to reduce isolation, particularly for older people and those who may otherwise feel disconnected.

It is also important to highlight that a well-run mosque is not just a place for prayer. It often becomes a center for community support and local charity work. In recent years, I have seen Muslim communities organise food drives, fundraising for local and international emergencies,

practical support for vulnerable families and projects that encourage volunteering and positive involvement among young people. This kind of community spirit benefits the wider borough, not only those who attend the mosque.

The former ambulance center is a sensible and appropriate building for this purpose. It is already an established community site, and bringing it back into active use in this way is far more practical than creating a new development. It also allows a previously underused building to become a positive asset for the area.

I understand the Council will need to consider issues such as traffic, parking, and local impact. However, I believe this proposal is reasonable and constructive, and I trust that the mosque committee will continue to work responsibly with local residents and the Council to ensure the site is managed in a considerate way.

For these reasons, I strongly support this planning application and I would be grateful if Sutton Council would look upon it favorably.

Yours faithfully

Dr Fouzia Moolla
Cheam, Sutton